led the fight from the front with a clear mind and clean heart. The stated aim of Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' was to strike at all terrorists without any distinction of good or bad Taliban. As expected, very soon, the terrorists started crumbling under the army's relentless onslaught. According to ISPR, at least 2,763 militants, including some known commanders, had been killed in ground operations and air strikes by June 2015. It added that 837 hideouts have been destroyed and 253 tons of explosives have been recovered. In the process, 347 military personnel have also lost their lives during the operation.

The positives of Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' were obvious. The command and control structure of TTP and many networks of terrorists were destroyed. By 2015, about 90 per cent of the FATA area had been purged of the terrorists, as claimed by Defence Minister of Pakistan Khawaja Muhammad Asif. The Prime Minister of Pakistan had stated, 'The operation Zarb-e-Azb has successfully destroyed terrorists' hideouts and networks'. Above all, according to a report by the US Department of State, Pakistan topped the list of countries with decreasing number of terrorist attacks. Thus, the short-term plan has been achieved.

The major flaw of this operation was that at the very inception the vital element of surprise was lost, which enabled the terrorists to take pre-emptive measures. The top leadership of TTP fled away to safe havens of the Pak-Afghan border or inside Afghanistan in Nuristan and Kunar provinces. Replicating the strategy of Afghan Taliban, most of them were defeated by initial military onslaught but managed to fight back after sometime. They kept launching dreadful terrorist attacks from their bases in Afghanistan.

Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' ended in 2016. However, as the insurgents continued their terrorist operations from across the border, Operation *Radd-ul-Fasaad* was started in February 2017. This operation aimed at annihilating the terrorists and their facilitators from the cities, with the support of the civil agencies, according to directions given in the National Action Plan.

Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' was primarily a counter-insurgency (COIN) campaign. It is a fight against asymmetrical warfare, which the militants fight under an ideology and motive to bring so-called political and social change. Terrorism is one tool of insurgency. The US COIN model suggests that establishing security is not a precursor to economic and governance activity: rather security, economic and governance activity